

UDL for Little Learners

Classroom Environment Audit

A self-reflection tool for early childhood teachers · Walk your own room. Come curious, not critical.

Teacher:	Date:	Grade / Setting:
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	What to look for in your space	What a student experiences	Notes / next step
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PHYSICAL SETUP & ACCESSIBILITY

☐	Materials are labeled with images AND words -- not words alone.	<i>I can find what I need without asking an adult.</i>	
☐	Supplies are stored at student height and accessible without permission.	<i>I can get what I need independently.</i>	
☐	There is a calm corner or regulation space that is clearly defined and teaches itself.	<i>I know where to go when I need a reset.</i>	
☐	Flexible seating options are available -- cushion, standing spot, floor with clipboard.	<i>I can work in a way that works for my body.</i>	
☐	There is enough space to move between zones without physical contact.	<i>I can move around without bumping into people.</i>	

INFORMATION STUDENTS CAN ACCESS ON THEIR OWN

☐	Visual schedule is posted and low enough for students to reference independently.	<i>I can check what comes next without asking.</i>	
☐	Anchor charts are co-created with students, image-supported, and at eye level.	<i>I helped make this. I know how to use it.</i>	
☐	Directions for independent work are visual and multimodal -- pictures alongside words.	<i>I can figure out what to do even if I can't read all the words.</i>	
☐	Student work displayed reflects the actual children in the room -- languages, families, identities.	<i>I can see myself in this space.</i>	
☐	There is a system for knowing what to do when stuck -- other than asking the teacher.	<i>I know what to do if I get confused.</i>	

CENTERS & INDEPENDENT WORK SPACES

☐	At least one center has visual directions so a non-reader can navigate it independently.	<i>I can start this without help.</i>	
☐	Centers have materials that allow for multiple entry points -- not all the same level.	<i>There's something here that's right for where I am.</i>	
☐	There is an accountability structure at centers -- recording sheet, partner role, finished-work spot.	<i>I know what done looks like.</i>	
☐	The small group table is set up and ready before students arrive.	<i>My teacher is ready. My turn matters.</i>	

WRITING & EXPRESSION

☐	Multiple writing tools are available -- pencils, markers, crayons, different paper types.	<i>I can use the tool that works best for me.</i>	
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☐	Scaffolds -- alphabet charts, word walls, sentence frames -- are visible and accessible to ALL students.	<i>Supports are for everyone, not just some kids.</i>	
☐	There is a visible example of what good work looks like -- an anchor or exemplar.	<i>I know what I am aiming for.</i>	

AFTER THE WALK -- THREE QUESTIONS TO SIT WITH

1. Which student in my room is most dependent on me to navigate the space? What is one thing I could change that would give them more independence?
2. Is there any student who has no seating option that genuinely works for their body or regulation needs?
3. If a brand new student walked in tomorrow, what could they figure out on their own -- and what would they still need to ask me?

What to Do Next

A completed audit is only useful if it leads somewhere. Here are four ways to put it to work.

1	Share one finding with your coach or a colleague.	Use it as your pre-observation focus: tell them what you already see working and what you want eyes on. The audit turns a general walkthrough into a targeted conversation.
2	Set one goal and attach a specific action.	Pick the item with the most checkboxes left blank. Write one concrete next step and a date: "By Friday I will add image labels to the materials shelf." The audit becomes your action plan.
3	Come back in six weeks and do it again.	A second completed audit next to this one shows growth in a specific, concrete way -- more meaningful than any general reflection.
4	Use it with your team.	Have everyone audit their own room, then share out one strength and one next step. It builds shared language and surfaces what is working across classrooms without feeling evaluative.

